THE WOMAN'S PAGE



THE SHANGHAI ART CLUB "AT HOME": AND OTHER EVENTS

Shanghai, Jan. 13.

Shanghai Art Club

An international air prevailed at the new Studio of the Shanghai Art Club, formally opened on Thursday with an "At home" given by the executive staff of the organisation which also sponsored an exhibit of dry-points by Mr. Ernst Halpern. Conveniently situated on the sixth floor of the Bearn Apartments, 453 Avenue Joffre, the new home of the Club has been especially designed to meet the requirements of the group. Seven great windows with a north-eastern exposure assure artists and exhibitors, alike, of perfect light, while a tastefully furnished conference room offers opportunities for informal discussions by small groups.

Present at the gathering were Mr. M. E. Meunier, chairman of the club, Mrs. R. J. Roberts, honorary secretary, and Mrs. A.M. Dunlap who assisted in receiving guests. In addition to representatives of the various educational institutions in Shanghai, the guest list included Mr. J. Meyrier, French Consulate General; Mr. J. Coiffard and Mr. Leurqurn, both of the French Consulate; Mr. and Mrs. Edwin S. Cunningham of the American Consulate, and Mr. Paul R. Josselyn, also of the American Consulate; Mr. and Mrs. A. de C. Sowerby; Mr. L. Chevrotton of the Banque de L'Indochine; Mr. Chien Yung-ming of the Joint Savings Society; His Excellency Mr. Li Yu-ling, former Minister of China in France, and Mr. Tsi Yachi of the Bank of Agriculture.

Enthusiastic approval of the new rooms was heard on every side as visitors noted the convenient floor plan. Entrance to the new quarters is gained through a small reception hall, to the left of which are the conference room, and a model's dressing room and shower. Directly facing the reception hall is the large semi-circular studio, which, it is hoped, will be used from time to time for small exhibits such as that by Mr. Halpern. The latter's shows incidentally, will remain open to the public to-day and to-morrow and is well worth a visit. A roof garden will offer a cool retreat to members and guests of the club when the present chilly gusts give way to the long summer heat wave.

The New Studio

Walls of the main Studio will be covered with a very light cream tint, and will be hung with representative examples of the achievements of club members loaned to the organisation. Several notable oils and water-colours were used to add contrasting colour to the delicate etchings shown by Mr. Halpern. A striking oil by Mr. Meunier, whose paintings are universally signed E. N. E. Muir, and a charcoal portrait with colour by Mr. F. Schiff were hung, together with a most effective still life in oils by Mrs. Roberts, and water-colour by Mr. E. Fraser, and Mr. George T. Squiers. A lovely water colour of the temple at Wei Hai Wei by Mrs. Roberts and a painting in oil of the Institute of Fine Arts, sister organisation of the Shanghai Art Club in Peking, was loaned for the conference room by Mrs. Dunlap. A lino-cut of the City Gate at Peking by Katherine Jowett represented the outport members of the local group.

An ambitious programme of activity featuring lectures by Mr. Teng Kwei, prominent in art circles here and abroad, has been outlined by the executive committees to stimulate interest in creative art locally. Mr. Kwei, who won distinction with his extensive lectures on Chinese art subject before American audiences, will conduct classes in sculpture and in Chinese painting. The latter, an entirely new venture by the Club, it is hoped will encourage a closer intimacy with the technique and understanding of Chinese painting generally. Mr. Kwei, at present conducting courses in Shanghai University, will discuss "Expressionism in Chinese Art" before members and associate members of the club on Friday, the 26th, at 2.30. His instruction will be given at 2.30 on Wednesdays and Fridays each week.

In addition to these items, the Studio will be open for artists to work in on Mondays when Mr. Pogurstky will continue his criticisms. Meanwhile, "open house" will be observed each Friday at the close of the lino-cut meetings. In no wise an art school, the Shanghai Art Club is primarily a meeting place for artists, and patrons of art to meet and to chat informally on topics of current interest in the realm of creative endeavor. Mrs. Dunlap, in charge of social activity and lectures, expressed her desire and that of the committees to encourage a universal and international spirit of co-operation in connection with things artistic in the Club and to foster interest in serious art appreciation, not in the didactic manner, but rather in the informal friendly fashion most likely to evoke active concern in the artistic sphere.

More than 70 names now appear on the membership roster, which is graced by the recently added name of Dr. Ann Walter Fearn, an honorary member, as well as numerous outport members residing in Hangchow, Hankow and Peking.

The Cocktail Party

Prolific as the writers of to-day may be on the subject of modern life, not one of them has yet written an adequate definition or spicy epigram about that phase of modern life known as the Cocktail Party. One wonders why. Perhaps they are afraid of offending their friends; or perhaps it is simply that cocktail parties have given way to other forms of entertainment in London and the other capitals.

But whatever the answer may be, the fact remains that, in Shanghai at any rate, cocktail parties still play a most important part in social life. People don't stop to define them. They go to them—and they enjoy them.

The past week has seen a number of cocktail parties. The impending departure of Col. and Mrs. Thoms gave rise to a most successful one which was given last Monday evening. Commander and Mrs. Doyle were their host and hostess, and though the gathering was a large one, the affair had all the pleasantness of informality. Col. and Mrs. Thoms were very busy saying goodbye to the numerous friends they have made these last two years in Shanghai. Col. and Mrs. Thoms have entered wholeheartedly into the life here and in addition to their general popularity they can count some very real friends amongst the people they have met here.

The party, by the way, was held in the beautiful Italian house on Tunsin Road which is the Doyle's home and in which Mrs. Doyle has used so much originality and artistic taste.

And Another

Another and still larger party was that given by Mr. and Mrs. G.-L. Wilson on Thursday evening. Even the trams in Avenue Joffre had to wait for the traffic and their vigourous bell clanging was no match for the stopping and starting, hooting and backing of the cars outside the Wilson's house. When one finally reached the inner precincts the reward was a really huge crowd of people, with the hostess, dressed in a new and very subtle shade of dark green which was most admirably suited to her colouring, in the midst receiving her guests.

Everybody was in a gay mood and conversation ran high, at one time reaching the stage when one's only hope of being heard was either to shout or to whisper—would that more people had whispered! However, it was a sure sign that everybody was enjoying themselves, and another merit of these large gatherings is that one renews acquintance with friends seldom met otherwise in rush of life in Shanghai. So greetings and "Happy New Years" could be heard on all sides amongst the guests last Thursday, and even a cocktail was abandoned in favour of a journey across the crowded room to find a "long-time-no-have-see" friend. We need hardly compliment the hostess—and, of course, the host, who is always most attentive to his guests' enjoyment on these occasions—on the success of her party. It is enough that there were over three hundred people there, and that the feminine guests were all wearing their smartest and best—the latter a very sure indication of a really successful event.

Joint Committee and B.W.A.

In the club world there is real activity these days. Yesterday evening the Musical Section of the B.W.A. held a very successful At Home at the Astor House Hotel—a departure from the usual, incidentally, for these affairs are generally held in their own headquarters. It was a pleasant change, however, and with Mrs. C. W. Smith the chairman receiving, the occasion was a good opportunity for committee and members to get to know one another. The underlying idea of the gathering was to discover new musical talent amongst members so that the modest ones should have a chance to come forward and perhaps contribute their part to the B.W.A. concert programmes.

Next Wednesday afternoon the Joint Committee of Shanghai Women's organisations will hold their annual general meeting in the B.W.A. rooms. This is a most important event and one which should have a record attendance of Shanghai's club women. The meeting is an open one—that is to say anyone who is a member of a club or organisation represented on the Joint Committee will be welcome. The first part of the meeting will be devoted to tea and the usual greetings which characterise those international gatherings. After that will come the review of the year's activities; so that the meeting is not only a delightful social occasion, but also an evidence of what club women of Shanghai are doing for their city.

Other Items

Other oddments of news that have been gleaned from stray corners (but authentic none the less) include the recent flutter amongst the Italian community of Shanghai on hearing that Signor Mussolini is the proud possessor of another grandchild. In other words, Count and Countess Ciano have now a baby daughter.

A departure must be recorded in Mr. and Mrs. H. C. Mei who are sailing on Tuesday on the President Coolidge for a holiday in Manila and Canton. The same ship will also carry away Mr. and Mrs. Alfred S. H. Lee who are combining business with pleasure in a trip to Manila and Hongkong.

Mr. Percy Cox is back from his holiday in Hongkong and was looking a picture of health when his friends saw him at the Wilson's cocktail party last Thursday.

To Write A Book

Yet another addition to Shanghai's long list of visitors is Mrs. Margaret Proctor Smith who is now spending some time in various parts of China and will be in Shanghai for the next few months. Musician and lecturer, Mrs. Smith, is in China with a view to collecting impressions for a book when she returns to the States. Contacts with such famous men of letters as Mr. Bernard Shaw and William Gerhardi in England, and addresses before American Women's Clubs in Berlin, Paris and Vienna are among the experiences of her travels. She is familiar with the East, having been entertained extensively during her journeyings through Ceylon, Egypt, Palestine and Syria. Her habit of entertaining all and sundry with anecdotes garnered from the four corners of the earth makes her a welcome guest and she has plenty of friends in China.

Already booked for an American lecture tour which will take more than one year to fulfill, Mrs. Smith plans several weeks in Shanghai before visiting friends in Soochow, Taichow, Wuhu and Hankow. Various entertainments have been arranged for Mrs. Smith during her stay here. She was the recent guest at a buffet tiffin at the home of Mrs. James Macbeth where more than twenty guests chatted informally on current topics of interest with the visitor. During the holiday weeks, she was the guest of honour at a tea dance at the French Club where Mr. and Mrs. Thomas Phillips entertained 80 guests. Mr. and Mrs. Phillips also entertained Mrs. Smith during the past week to a tea attended by twenty at the French Club.

In 1924, Mrs. Smith came to China and for a year worked voluntarily, shouldering her own expenses in an Episcopal mission here. After which she returned to the States, where she lectured on the Chinese situation from an unprejudiced standpoint.

Another visit of three years in 1926, persuaded Mrs. Smith that China was definitely progressing in all phases of modern adaptation. Her world tour took her back again to the States for some time, before repeated requests for a book incorporating her lectures on "China Goes Forward" necessitated the present trip to the Far East.

"Among Those Present. . . "

A friend writes from France saying that now little dogs attend dress shows in Paris. They insist on being taken, being accustomed to go everywhere with their mistresses, and so to the serried rows of onlookers are added Pekes, bulldogs, Sealyhams, Manchester terriers, Poms—most of whom speak only French and the majority of which wear woolly vests, waistcoats, capes of varying colours. Most little dogs insist on wearing knitting, as it is at once fashionable and comfortable. It must be, however, the sort of knitting which does not evoke an unconquerable desire to scratch when the central heating is in full blast and the windows are hermetically sealed and the attendance is more than the room will actually hold. From out their woolly waistcoats they look at each other—some from the vantage-point of a knee, some from the floor upon which they have laid their noses in the pretence of looking at no one. If a Pom stirs there is a quiver of excitement in the opposite Pekinese. If a bulldog shuffles his hairy collar the Sealyham at the other end of the room immediately becomes taut.

Sometimes a short yap means that someone would like water, on the principle that water should accompany central heating. But water is brought and eagerly accepted by the respective griffon or terrier. If visitors to the shows cast searching and sidelong glances at their rivals the dogs are far more tense about it all, and not a hair can flutter or a waistcoat breathe heavily without an alert interest on the part of its neighbours. Dress-show little dogs sometimes take a violent exception to other dress-show little dogs. There is then a yapping match—a sort of anthem from a canine choir on either side of the salon. And when at last it is over they all get down and stretch and yawn and look bored, though they are only ready to go to the next and to be admired by those whose business it is to curry favour with their owners.

BIRTH

WELLS.—On January 9, 1934, at the Country Hospital, Shanghai, to Mr. and Mrs. W. D. WELLS, a son.

SAWYER.—To Mr. and Mrs. A. W. SAWYER, at Southampton, England, on January 6, 1934, a daughter.

GREINER.—On January 13, 1934, at the Country Hospital, Shanghai, to MR. and MRS. J. GREINER, a son.

DEATHS

OTHMER.—On January 7, 1934, at Goettingen, Germany, PROFESSOR Dr. h.c. W. OTHMER, aged 52.

FREDRIKSEN.—On Tuesday, January 9, 1934, at Dr. Noll's Hospital, Shanghai, JOHN FREDRIKSEN, Norwegian Officer, aged 2[illegible] years.

BELL.—On Tuesday, January 9, 1934, at her home, Dixwell Terrace, ANNIE BELL, aged 84 years. The relict of the late Capt. Geo. E. Bell.

LOPES.—On Thursday, January 11, 1934, at her residence 177/1 Avenue Dubail, MARIA ANTONIA NORONHA LOPES, aged 78 years. The dearly beloved mother of Mrs. H. Lachlan, Mrs. J. C. Guterres, Mrs. I. M. Rozario, Evelina Lopes, A. A. Lopes, J. M. C. Lopes and S. A. Lopes.

TOMLIN.—On Wednesday, January 10, 1934, at the Sacred Heart Hospital, EDITH TOMLIN, aged 20 years.

KILES.—On Wednesday, January 10, 1934, at the Shanghai General Hospital, GERARD KILES, aged 33 years.

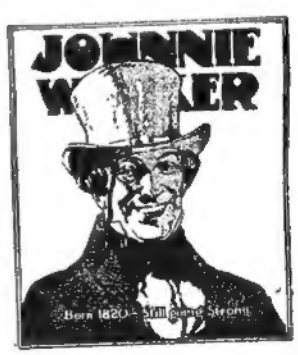
MOORE.—On Thursday, Jan. 11, 1934, at the Paulun Hospital, Shanghai, Mrs. ROBERT JAMES MOORE, aged 30 years.

MARRIAGE

MITCHELL—TOMLINSON. — On January 12, 1934, at Holy Trinity Cathedral, Shanghai, by the Very Rev. Dean A. C. S. Trivett, M.A., D.D., GEORGE EDWARD, second son of Edward James Mitchell, of Brighton, Sussex, and the late Mrs. Mitchell, to KATHLEEN MARY, only child of Mr. and Mrs. John Tomlinson, of Leasingham Hall, Sleaford, Lincs.

ENGAGEMENT

MORRIS—BEESLEY.—The engagement is announced of JULIA BEESLEY, younger daughter of Mrs. P. M. Beesley, of Shanghai, to Mr. G. H. A. Morris, of St. Helens, Lancs.



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